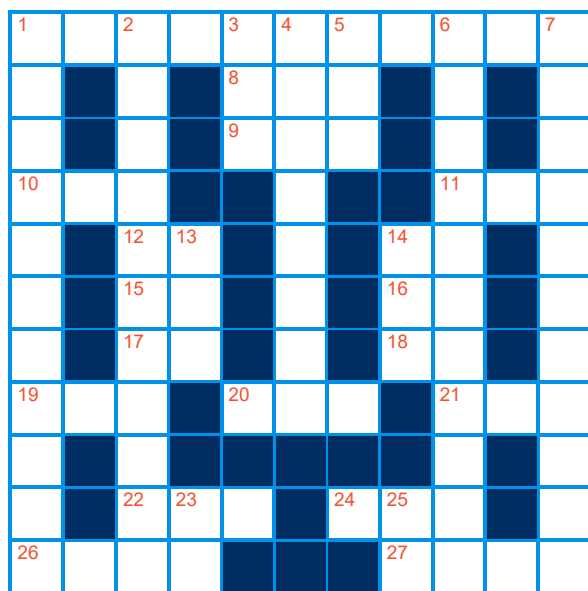




Across

- 1 They buy sneakers, too, according to Jordan's justification for remaining an apolitical public figure. (11)
- 8 "Now I get it!" - in contemporary text slang. (3)
- 9 One of Nike's many iconic Jordan posters featured this as the background, a nod to His Airness's leaping ability. (3)
- 10 '90s cat that aired along many a Jordan commercial during Saturday morning kids programming. (3)
- 11 Air Jordan release prominently featured in *The Fresh Prince of Bel Air*, briefly. (3)
- 12 You take this when losing, or riding a raised train. (2)
- 14 As much as he was a master of the game, so too was Jordan a master of this. (2)
- 15 The alma mater of the player drafted immediately after 27 Across, briefly. (2)
- 16 Abbreviation for the ailment list not used in either of Jordan's pro sports (it's *reserved* for football and hockey). (2)
- 17 Abbreviation for the alma mater of Dana Barros who, despite playing against Jordan's Bulls as a Sonic and Celtic for nearly ten years, never met them in the playoffs. (2)
- 18 The Egyptian god that ruled the 9 Across. (2)
- 19 In addition to talent, Jordan had plenty of this. (3)
- 20 The color most synonymous with Jordan's jerseys. (3)
- 21 Title for Barkley when referring to him by his royal nickname. (3)
- 22 The kind of person Jordan's work on screen was often targeting. (3)
- 24 Franchise that fell victim to Jordan in its only two Finals appearances, briefly. (3)
- 26 Jordan's teammates were never afraid to dish him the ball, but they were always afraid to give him any of this. (4)
- 27 The center the Blazers took ahead of *another* Hall of Fame scorer, long after the Bowie/Jordan mistake. (4)
- adult, for that matter) wanted to become when Jordan was at the peak of his popularity. (8)
- 5 One way to describe the relationship between Michael Jordan and Jerry Krause. (3)
- 6 MJ was one of many players to be introduced as this Inside Stuff host's "main man" in the '90s. (11)
- 7 Comedian who partnered with Michael Jordan in a the faux exposé "Johnny Kilroy" commercial. (11)
- 13 First name of the 72-win Bulls' starting center. (3)
- 14 Word that can precede *bag*, *guitar*, *lift*, and of course, Jordan. (3)
- 23 It __ what it __. (2)
- 25 A (*brief*) period in basketball which set the stage for several of Jordan's most iconic moments. (2)

Down

- 1 Jordan did this, in the title of the 30 for 30 Film about his minor league baseball stint. (11)
- 2 Both Jordan and Bulls ownership knew how to keep these full. (11)
- 3 Despite allowing him to score 39.7 points per game, this team (briefly) kept Jordan from advancing to the second round of the '86 and '87 playoffs. (3)
- 4 What many a 22 Across (and many an